ROOTEDWITHKHETHIWE

School of the Prophets

FOUNDATIONS



LESSON 02 / 05

Build the Altar

Give prayer a permanent place

SCRIPTURE / TEACHING / PRACTICE

Build the Altar

READ IN WEB • Matthew 6:5–13 · Romans 12:1–2 · 1 Kings 19:9–18

Come before you ask

Read Matthew 6 slowly. Jesus draws attention to whom we are speaking to and teaches us to begin with the Father’s name, kingdom and will. Daily bread, forgiveness and deliverance also belong in the same prayer. Take one concern you have brought repeatedly to God. Pray for His will in it, name the ordinary need under it, and consider whether there is forgiveness or repair that belongs in your own response. Give yourself time to stay with the passage even if no new impression comes.

Offer an ordinary life

Paul connects the offering of our bodies with the renewal of our minds in Romans 12. Consecration touches how we use time, how we speak and how we handle what belongs to others. Notice one place where your prayer and your habits tell different stories. If you are praying for patience with your family, choose one moment in the day to practise it deliberately. The habit gives your prayer somewhere concrete to land.

Listen and return

In 1 Kings 19, Elijah’s encounter in the cave is part of a larger story. He has already received food and rest, and he eventually receives further instructions and learns that others remain faithful. Read the whole sequence and notice what happens before and after the encounter. Bring your own need for rest, company and wise counsel into your prayer practice. The rhythm of *Build the Altar* makes room for Scripture, reflection, prayer and attentive listening, then invites you to return when you miss a day.

Practice and reflection

Practice · A seven-day prayer rhythm

Set aside ten minutes at a time you can realistically keep. Read a short passage for three minutes. Write one sentence about what the passage shows you. Pray for yourself and one other person, then leave a quiet moment to listen. Record what came to mind in a separate line from what you read. Close by naming one response you can carry into the day.

Choose a steady passage for the first three days, such as Matthew 6:9–13. Revisit the same words and watch which parts you hurry past. For the next four days, try Romans 12:1–2, then return to your first entry. Look for a change in how you prayed or responded during the week.

When the room feels quiet

A quiet day still gives you Scripture to return to and a person to pray for. If a thought feels urgent, write it down and consider it again after prayer and rest. For significant direction, seek counsel before taking action. If you miss a day, resume at the next available moment and keep the same simple rhythm.

Journal and pray

Which time and place will help me return tomorrow? What habit needs to come under the same prayer I keep praying? Who am I willing to carry faithfully in intercession this week?

Father, make prayer a settled part of my life. Bring my ordinary habits before You and teach me to return with honesty, even when the room feels quiet. Amen.

SOURCE • Build the Altar, “How to Use This Journal” and its prayer rhythm.

Scripture readings

Matthew 6:5–13

5 “When you pray, you shall not be as the hypocrites, for they love to stand and pray in the synagogues and in the corners of the streets, that they may be seen by men. Most certainly, I tell you, they have received their reward.

6 But you, when you pray, enter into your inner room, and having shut your door, pray to your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you openly.

7 In praying, don’t use vain repetitions as the Gentiles do; for they think that they will be heard for their much speaking.

8 Therefore don’t be like them, for your Father knows what things you need before you ask him.

9 Pray like this: “‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.

10 Let your Kingdom come. Let your will be done on earth as it is in heaven.

11 Give us today our daily bread.

12 Forgive us our debts, as we also forgive our debtors.

13 Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one. For yours is the Kingdom, the power, and the glory forever. Amen.’

Romans 12:1–2

1 Therefore I urge you, brothers, by the mercies of God, to present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, which is your spiritual service.

2 Don’t be conformed to this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may prove what is the good, well-pleasing, and perfect will of God.

1 Kings 19:9–18

9 He came to a cave there, and camped there; and behold, the LORD’s word came to him, and he said to him, “What are you doing here, Elijah?”

10 He said, “I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of Armies; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.”

11 He said, “Go out and stand on the mountain before the LORD.” Behold, the LORD passed by, and a great and strong wind tore the mountains and broke in pieces the rocks before the LORD; but the LORD was not in the wind. After the wind there was an earthquake; but the LORD was not in the earthquake.

12 After the earthquake a fire passed; but the LORD was not in the fire. After the fire, there was a still small voice.

13 When Elijah heard it, he wrapped his face in his mantle, went out, and stood in the entrance of the cave. Behold, a voice came to him, and said, “What are you doing here, Elijah?”

Scripture readings continued

1 Kings 19:9–18 (continued)

14 He said, “I have been very jealous for the LORD, the God of Armies; for the children of Israel have forsaken your covenant, thrown down your altars, and killed your prophets with the sword. I, even I only, am left; and they seek my life, to take it away.”

15 The LORD said to him, “Go, return on your way to the wilderness of Damascus. When you arrive, anoint Hazael to be king over Syria.

16 Anoint Jehu the son of Nimshi to be king over Israel; and anoint Elisha the son of Shaphat of Abel Meholah to be prophet in your place.

17 He who escapes from the sword of Hazael, Jehu will kill; and he who escapes from the sword of Jehu, Elisha will kill.

18 Yet I reserved seven thousand in Israel, all the knees of which have not bowed to Baal, and every mouth that has not kissed him.”